Guidelines for Grades: Group Project Marking Scheme (BSc Digital Forensics & Cyber Security)

Student Names: _____ _____ _____

Section	Weighting	Criteria (Distinction)	Criteria (Merit)	Criteria (Pass)	Criteria (Fail)	Weighted Mark
Introduction: *Abstract, Research Questions, Objectives*	5%	Problem is clearly stated, and given in context of sufficient background information. Student demonstrates a deep understanding of the problem and its IT security implications and position within Security, Forensics and Ethical Circumvention.	Problem is stated but requires further clarification. Minor background information given. Students demonstrates adequate understanding of the problem but lacks clear positioning within context of IT Security, Forensics or Ethical Circumvention.	Problem definition is vague requiring further clarification. Some background information given. Students demonstrates minimal understanding of the problem. System lacks clear positioning within context of IT Security, Forensics or Ethical Circumvention.	Problem not clearly defined or not at the appropriate academic level of difficulty. Insufficient background information given. Insufficient understanding of the problem or how such systems are positioned within context of IT Security and Forensics	
Literary Review: *Scope and quality of background research; use of literature*	10%	Strong knowledge of relevant literature demonstrated, and provides deep critical evaluation of previous work done in the area, highlighting flaws in present security systems using ethical hacking methods	Good knowledge of literature demonstrated, some more relevant than others. Adequate attempt to evaluate previous work done in the area. Flaws in prior work highlighted based on observation and citation rather than testing.	Some knowledge of literature. Little attempt to evaluate previous work done in the area. Few flaws in prior work are highlighted with little evidence of further investigation on part of student.	Inadequate knowledge of relevant literature demonstrated. No critical evaluation of previous work in the area shown. No appropriate flaws in present security systems highlighted or investigated.	
Methodology	10%	Thesis demonstrates a thorough understanding of how to address the research question, and gives a sound justification for choices made in terms of securing the system	Thesis demonstrates good understanding of how to address the research question, and appropriate choices have been made with some justification in terms of securing the system	Minor understanding of how to address research question demonstrated. Reasons for choices made to secure the system are vague.	Very little understanding of how to address the research question, and no sound justification for, or appropriate choices made to secure the system	
Implementation: *Experimentation. Technical quality and depth*	30%	Quality of work demonstrates a thoroughness & clarity in practical approach and outcomes. Evidence of focused, relevant experimentation to answer research question. Circumvention and mitigation measures of system demonstrated	Good quality work for specified academic level, falls short on some sections. Evidence of experimentation to answer the research question. Circumvention and mitigation measures approached.	Minimum quality for specified academic level, falls short on several sections of practical implementation. Minor evidence of experimentation, circumvention or mitigation measures.	Quality of work falls short of required academic level. Little understanding of practical technicalities. No evidence of experimentation to answer research question. No attempt at circumvention or mitigation measures.	
Analysis: *Critical Evaluation, Testing, Discussion on findings*	25%	Comprehensive evaluation with respect to Objective/ Research question. Identification of improvements using appropriate test data calculations and failure rates. Strong conclusion about test results with supported evidence	Good evaluation with respect to Objective/Research question. Identification of improvements. Adequate conclusion about test results.	Some evaluation of data with respect to Objective/Research question. Few improvements identified. Minimal value in conclusion about test results.	No evaluation with respect to Objective/Research question. No identification of improvements or sufficient attempt at test data calculations or failure rates. No conclusion about test results.	
Overall Thesis Quality:	10%	Excellent quality of overall presentation with well-structured arguments written in high quality English. Focuses the security theme within Forensics, Security and/or Circumvention/Ethical Hacking. Thesis structured in a logical, coherent manner with good flow between sections. Graphs/ Figures are well chosen and helpful. Excellent referencing with complete citations given.	Good quality overall presentation with well written English. Security theme identified within relevant domain of Forensics, Security or Circumvention /Ethical Hacking. Thesis structured in a mostly logical and coherent manner. Some structural flaws in flow between sections. Graphs/ Figures are well chosen. Good referencing with citations given.	Basic standard presentation. Some flaws in written style and argument. Weak on specifics about security theme and usefulness. Not structured in a logical or coherent manner overall. Some structural flaws in flow between sections. Graphs/ Figures, referencing and citations are minimal but adequate.	Weak standard presentation. Many flaws in written style and argument. No specifics definition about project's security theme and usefulness. Not structured in a logical or coherent manner. Many structural flaws in flow between sections. Some sections missing.	
Presentation:	10%	See separate document				

Comments:

Grade awarded: _____